

What exact scientific claim does the evaluator want to make?

BRANCH A Matched descriptive comparison

Did recorded runs share the declared schedule?

BRANCH B Statistically paired inference

Is the estimator's reference distribution justified?

BRANCH C Deterministic replay

Does one artifact reproduce its declared projection?

BRANCH D CRN variance reduction

Does a valid coupling reduce variance?

BRANCH E Event-aligned counterfactual / mechanism

Did matched events receive equal random values?

Branches are alternatives by claim objective - not a cumulative ladder.